

Day 5 — When a Habitat Changes

"The Return of the Frogs" · students read wetland frog-count data, graph it, read why the frogs came back, and write a claim with evidence.

Three tiers, one task

Tiers A, B, and C are the **same lesson at different support levels** — not different work. Every student reads the same data and writes the same kind of claim; only the **graph scaffolding** and the **reading level** change. The **data table** and the **writing frame** are identical for everyone.

Print ~4 pages per student — not all 9

This master holds every page so you can see the whole lesson. For students, print the **single tier stack** that fits each child (about 4 pages each): Day-05-Tier-A / -B / -C .pdf.

- **Tier A** — most support. Two bars pre-drawn; shortest reading with key words bolded. For emerging readers / graphers and many MLL students.
- **Tier B** — grade level. Student graphs all four bars; one-paragraph reading. The default for most of the class.
- **Tier C** — most challenge. Student titles and labels the graph; longer reading that asks them to infer cause and effect.

The writing frame includes Spanish stems for every student.

Page guide (this master is grouped by tier)

Page	Content
1	This cover
2	Data table — <i>shared by all tiers</i>
3–4	Tier A — graph + reading
5–6	Tier B — graph + reading
7–8	Tier C — graph + reading

The Return of the Frogs

Step 1 · Read the data

Volunteers restored the wetland at Marsh Creek. Every May, the 4th-grade class counted the frogs. Here is what they found.

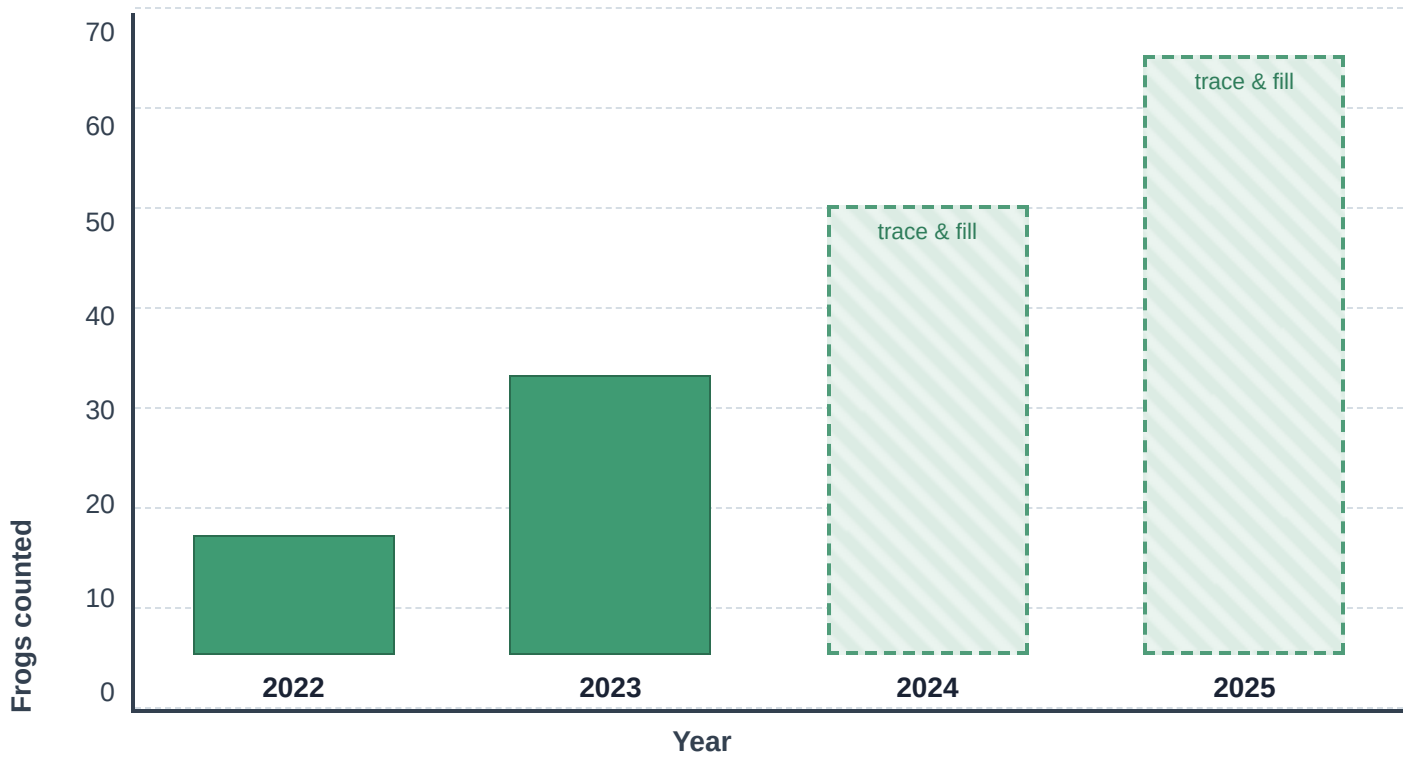
Year	Frogs counted
2022	12
2023	28
2024	45
2025	60

Data collected each May at Marsh Creek Wetland, 2022–2025.

Talk it over: What do you notice about the numbers from 2022 to 2025?

Frogs at Marsh Creek Wetland

Two bars are done for you. **Trace and fill** the two dashed bars to match the data table.



DAY 5 · STEP 3 · READ · TIER A

Why did the frogs come back?

A wetland is a habitat. It has water, plants, and food.

For years the wetland was **dirty**. Only a few frogs could live there.

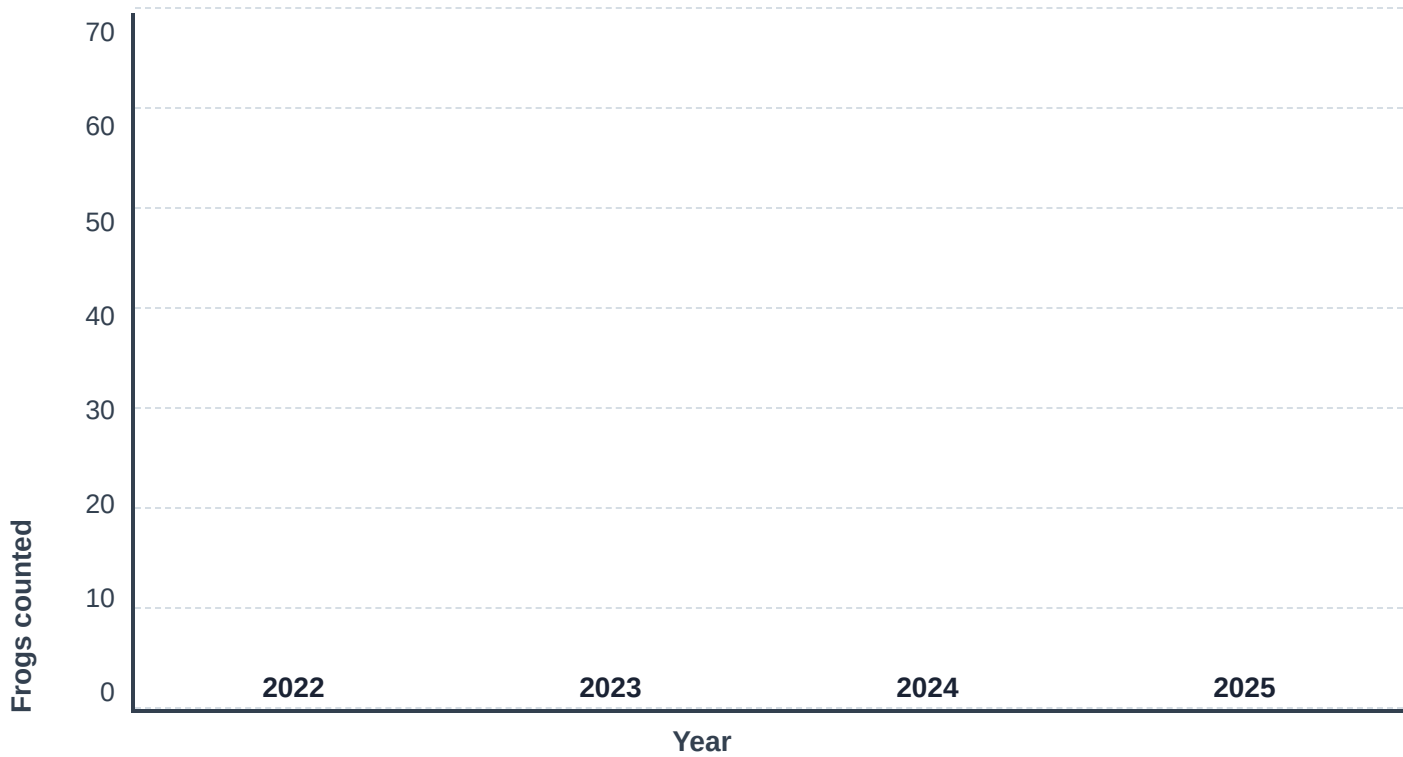
Then people **cleaned** it. The water got clean. New plants grew. Bugs came back for the frogs to eat.

Now many frogs live in the wetland. The frogs came back because the habitat gave them what they need: **food, water, shelter, and space**.

Underline the four things every habitat must give an animal.

Frogs at Marsh Creek Wetland

Use the data table to **draw all four bars** at the right height.



DAY 5 · STEP 3 · READ · TIER B

Why did the frogs come back?

A wetland is a habitat where water meets land.

Years ago, this wetland was polluted, and only a few frogs could survive there. Then a group of volunteers cleaned up the trash and planted native reeds along the water. As the water grew cleaner, **insects** returned — and insects are **food** for frogs. The new plants gave frogs **shelter** to hide from herons and a safe place to lay eggs.

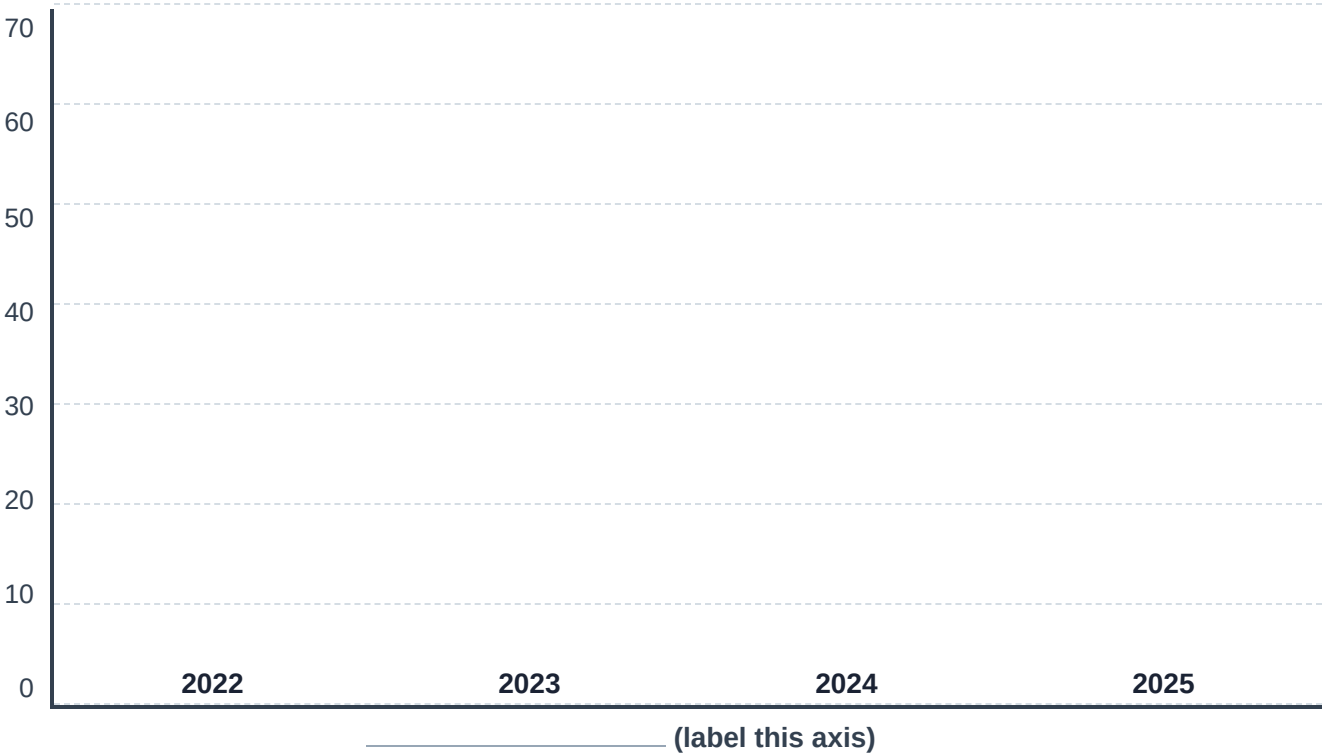
Little by little, the frog population grew. The frogs came back because the habitat once again met their needs: **food, water, shelter, and space**.

Underline the four things every habitat must give an animal.

DAY 5 · STEP 2 · GRAPH · TIER C

_____ (write a title)

Draw all four bars from the data. Then write the graph title and label both axes yourself.



DAY 5 · STEP 3 · READ · TIER C

Why did the frogs come back?

For decades, runoff from nearby roads left this wetland polluted and choked with litter. Frogs are especially sensitive to pollution because they breathe partly through their skin, so as the water quality fell, the frog population collapsed — only a dozen remained.

In 2022, volunteers began restoring the wetland: hauling out trash, replanting native reeds, and slowing the polluted runoff. Cleaner water let aquatic insects return, rebuilding the frogs' food supply, while the new reeds offered shelter from predators and a protected place to lay eggs. One by one, each habitat need — **food, water, shelter, and space** — was restored, and the data shows the result.

Underline the four things every habitat must give an animal.

DAY 5 · STEP 4 · WRITE · **EVERYONE****Make a claim from the evidence**

What happened to the frog population, and why? Write a **claim**, support it with **evidence** from the data and the reading, and explain your **reasoning**.

Claim

The frog population _____ from 2022 to 2025.

La población de ranas _____ de 2022 a 2025.

Evidence

I know this because the data shows _____.

The reading says _____.

Lo sé porque los datos muestran _____. La lectura dice _____.

Reasoning

This happened because the habitat gave the frogs _____, _____, _____, and _____.

Esto pasó porque el hábitat les dio a las ranas comida, agua, refugio y espacio.

Word bank: food / water / shelter / space · comida / agua / refugio / espacio
